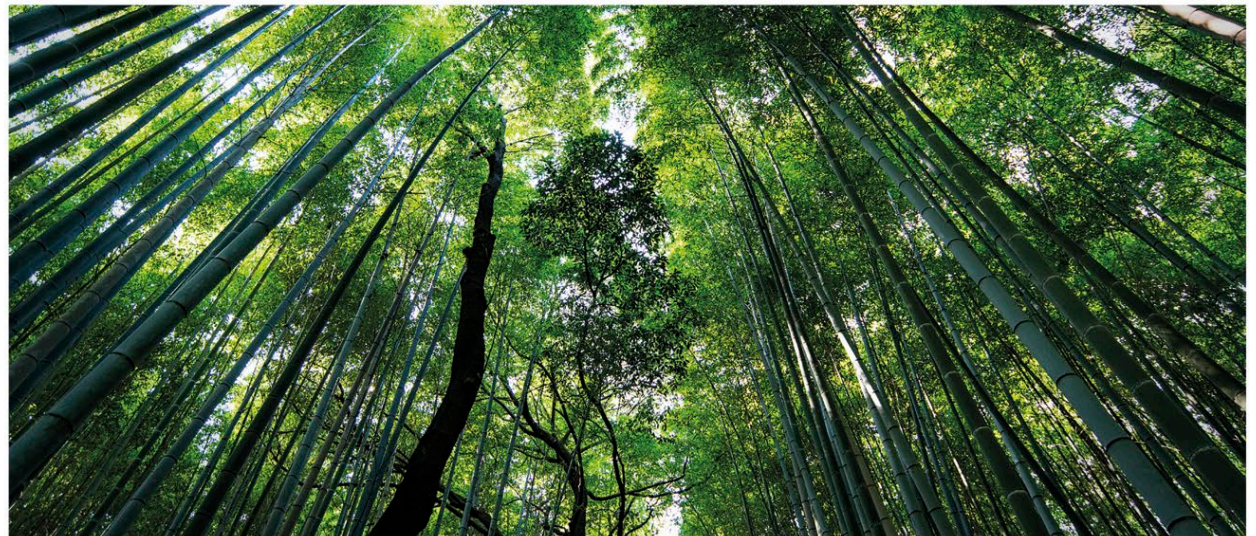


► TALL STALKS OF BAMBOO AT SAGANO BAMBOO FOREST

Nansei Shoto Archipelago Forest

Location Ryukyu archipelago, southwest Japan

This archipelago consists of a long chain of larger volcanic and smaller coral islands between southern Japan and Taiwan and China. It has many tracts of subtropical moist broadleaf forest, which benefit from warm winters, hot summers, and high rainfall. The forest has a unique mix of fauna and flora, including many species that are found nowhere else on Earth. The Iriomote Islands contain the world's only habitat for the rare and endangered Iriomote cat. The Amami rabbit is another species endemic to the archipelago. The largest tract of forest is on Okinawa and is home to a woodpecker and a rail, both endemic to the island and bearing its name.



Xishuangbanna Rain Forest

Location Near Jinghong, Yunnan, China

This is the largest area of tropical China still covered by native forest. Despite the forest's high elevation (above 1,640 ft/500 m), it has most of the characteristics of

the lowland rain forest found in southeast Asia. This is partly because it is protected from cold northerly winds in winter by the Hengduan Mountains. An extraordinary variety of more than 3,300 species of trees and other plants grow at Xishuangbanna. Some trees grow to a height of more than 260 ft (80 m).

Other forests in Asia

- **Bornean Rain Forest**
» pp.258-59
- **Eastern Himalayan Forest**
» p.256
- **Taiheiyō Montane Forest**
» p.256
- **Siberian Taiga** » pp.254-55
- **Upper Yangtze Forests** » p.257

